E Mich 7 Grammar notes

Possessives: *"my NOUN, your NOUN, mine, yours"*

- The most common way of saying that things belong to somebody is to use a **POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVE**. Like all adjectives (see F Mich 9), they have to **agree with what they describe** (NOT with the owner). **The starred* masc.sing. forms are also used in front of any feminine singular noun starting with a vowel** *(mon ami, mon amie,)*

	masc sing	*fem sing*	*plural*	
▪	mon*	ma	mes	
▪	ton*	ta	tes	
▪	son*	sa	ses	
▪	notre		notre	nos
▪	votre		votre	vos
▪	leur		leur	leurs

▪	*mon frère*	*ma soeur*	*mes parents*	*etc.*

- The main thing to remember is to make them agree with what is owned, not the owner. Sometimes this may be **ambiguous** "*son frère*" could mean "*his brother*" or "*her brother*". Usually, the context makes it clear, but if not, you use "*à*" plus a **DISJUNCTIVE PRONOUN** - "*son frère à lui*" rather than "*son frère à elle*".

- You may also use the disjunctive pronouns to indicate possession in the following ways:

▪	*Ce stylo est à moi/ est à nous / est à eux*	etc

- **The way to ask who something belongs to** is to say:

  - **À qui est** ….*(ce livre/cette cassette)* **?**
  - or **C'est à qui**… *(ce livre/ cette cassette)***?**

- And of course you can answer with "*c'est à moi*", or by using a POSSESSIVE PRONOUN. The pronoun will of course agree with the thing owned, not the owner:

▪	*le mien*	*la mienne*	*les miens*	*les miennes*	**MINE**
▪	*le tien*	*la tienne*	*les tiens*	*les tiennes*	**YOURS**
▪	*le sien*	*la sienne*	*les siens*	*les siennes*	**HIS/HERS**
▪	*le nôtre*	*la nôtre*	*les nôtres*	*les nôtres*	**OURS**
▪	*le vôtre*	*la vôtre*	*les vôtres*	*les vôtres*	**YOURS**
▪	*le leur*	*la leur*	*les leurs*	*les leurs*	**THEIRS**

- Note the **accent over the NOUS and VOUS forms** – it affects pronunciation.

- *C'est à qui cette chaise? Elle est à moi. C'est la mienne.*
  À qui sont ces livres? Ils sont à nous. Ce sont les nôtres.
  Mon stylo ne marche plus - je peux utiliser le tien, s'il te plaît?
  David a de la chance - ma grand-mère est morte, mais la sienne est vivante.

The conditional tense

- The conditional tense is used to describe:
  - **What you would be doing** *(I would be eating)*
  - **What you would do** *(I would eat)*

- To form the conditional tense, simply:
  - **Take the infinitive** (removing the final E of –RE verbs) manger, finir, vendre
  - Add the correct personal ending:

je	PARLER – **ais**
tu	FINIR – **ais**
il/elle	VENDR – **ait**
nous	RÉUSSIR – **ions**
vous	RENCONTRER – **iez**
ils	RENDR – **aient**

- **This tense is a mixture of the FUTURE and the IMPERFECT TENSE.** The stems are the same as for the future and the endings are the same as for the imperfect. Revise the **irregular future stems** from E Mich 3: they are not repeated **here.**

Some spelling changes in the conditional tense

- **The spelling changes for the future tense** (E Mich 3) also affect verbs in the conditional tense. *(j'achèterais, nous achèterions, j'essuierais, nous essuierions)*

A second "if…" clause

- You learned a 1st "si clause" in E Mich 5. This is the second one, and is extremely useful for saying "**what would happen if something else happened**":

  - **Si + imperfect + conditional** (or conditional + si + imperfect)
  - *Si j'étais riche, j'achèterais une nouvelle voiture.*
    Je ferais plus d'exercice si j'avais plus de temps
    Si elle m'invitait au restaurant, j'accepterais volontiers.